

Fedora doesn't include that in its official repositories.

As furious as I was... in a rage I ended up selecting all the seven packages listed under the 'Virtualization' section in PackageKit (Figure 1) to see what KVM had to offer me. It turned out that KVM is not bad at all. I have even configured a network bridge—needs more steps when it's a VirtualBox—by simply editing a couple of files by hand. But more about that later... Let me first walk you down the path of easily creating virtual machines using this nifty GUI wizard called Virt-Manager using KVM.

Click Next—step-by-step

Now that you have the required tools installed (you did install the tools, didn't you? See Figure 1), it's time to run another 'guest' OS from within Fedora 10. Launch the Virt-Manager from *Applications menu*→*System Tools*→*Virtual Machine Manager*. It'll prompt you for a root password—yes, you can run it under the under-privileged mode as a normal user too, but that's another story.

This will launch a bare-bones empty window as shown in Figure 2. Click on *File*→*Add Connection...* This will bring up the window where you need to select the hypervisor that Virt-Manager will use. By default, it will show Xen. Click on the drop-down menu and select *QEMU*, because KVM uses this one to function. Let the *Connection* type remain 'Local', as we'll create the virtual machine on the local system. Now, click the *Connect* button. A *localhost* entry will appear in the Virt-Manager window.

Now we can click on the *New* button at the bottom right corner of the window to create a new virtual system (Figure 3), with information on the steps to follow. However, before we do that it's better we set up the networking system that will aid our guest OS first.

Networking anyone?

There can be two types of networking—a virtual network (viz. NAT), or a shared physical device (your Ethernet card). The former is okay, if you don't want to access your guest OS from the host system—which is also the default in VirtualBox. This is configured in Virt-Manager by default. To check it, click *Edit*→*Connection Details...* This brings up the 'Host Details' window. Select the tab that says *Virtual Networks*. There should be an interface called *default* listed on the left-side pane, with the details of the network on the right side as shown in Figure 4.

But just in case this screen is empty, there's no reason to panic. Clicking the + [plus] button at the lower left corner of the window brings up a new wizard for creating the virtual network with details of the steps to follow. Click *Forward* and set the name of the network to whatever you like (viz. *default*). The next window gives an IP range; the default 192.168.100.0/24 is cool. The next screen lists the DHCP beginning and end of the IP range. The default again is okay. The following window is a bit tricky—you have an option between an 'isolated virtual network' or 'forwarding to physical network'. If you want the Internet to work on the

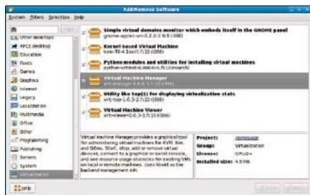


Figure 1: PackageKit: Where's Xen? It's only KVM

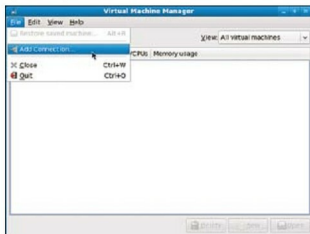


Figure 2: Virt-Manager first run

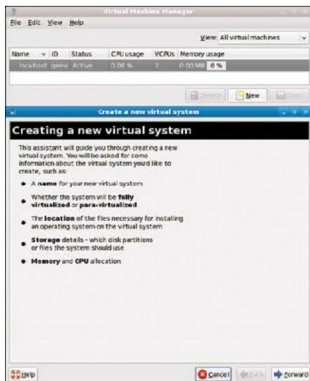


Figure 3: Create a new virtual system